rainfall in the first half of October may have affected *Postrera* crops in certain areas.

According to INETER (the Geosciences Institute), there was a slight cumulative rainfall deficit in September, with cumulative rainfall totals for the month of October expected to show an improvement over previous months. The rains are expected to taper off at the end of October, with the dry season getting underway by the first week of November, though there could be continued rainfall activity in humid areas of the North and South Atlantic Autonomous Regions and extremely mountainous areas of the country's Northern and Central Regions. The excessive rainfall in the first half of October affected some 37 municipalities in 13 departments.

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EL SALVADOR: Rainfall levels in eastern and western areas of the country are within normal ranges for the *Postrera* growing season, which is conducive to crop growth and development (Figure 1).

Coffee Sector

The coffee harvest got underway in the second week of October in many coffee-producing areas in the countries of the region. Expected improvements in coffee production and international prices should help increase labor demand.

The progress of the growing season is expected to jump-start the coffee sector, with the rust outbreak under better control, the positive biannual nature of coffee production, and the rebound in international prices, which should help the coffee sector reestablish itself as one of the largest generators of agricultural Gross Domestic Product (GDP) and employers of the economically active population in each country. Estimates for the 2014/2015 season (Figure 2) show an improvement in production levels over last season, primarily in areas where coffee growers invested in rehabilitating their plantations, which should start producing coffee as of this year, though the rebound in coffee production will still not reach the production levels of 2011/2012.